DISASTER PREPAREDNESS KIT · OPTION 3

72-Hour Pandemic Preparedness Kit

Tailored for a college student in on-campus housing · United States

Disaster Type
Respiratory Pandemic

Coverage
72 hours minimum

User Profile
Dorm resident, limited storage

72h
Shelter-in-place coverage without leaving for supplies

6
Kit sections — A through F, all compact and portable

~$160
Estimated total cost for full kit assembly (items to purchase)

A Medical & Infection Control

N95 / KN95 Masks (×10) — ~$18
High-filtration; core WHO non-pharmaceutical intervention
Search on Amazon ↗

Hand Sanitizer ≥70% alcohol — ~$6
Travel-size; refillable
Target ↗

Disinfecting Wipes — ~$5
For high-touch surfaces in shared dorm spaces
CVS ↗

Rapid Antigen Test Kits (×2) — ~$30
Pathogen-specific when available; enables early isolation
Walgreens ↗

Digital Thermometer — ~$8
Fever monitoring for self-triage decisions
Amazon ↗

Ibuprofen / Acetaminophen + Cough Drops — ~$6
Fever reducer and symptom management
CVS ↗

B Water & Food

Water — 3 liters — ~$5
Bottled or reusable filled container; 2L/day recommended — supplement with campus access if available
Target ↗

Shelf-Stable Food (72h supply) — ~$15
Energy bars, instant noodles, nut butter packets
Amazon ↗

Electrolyte Packets — ~$8
Hydration support during fever or vomiting
Amazon ↗

C Communication & Information

High-Capacity Power Bank — ~$20
10,000+ mAh; wireless networks may overload in emergencies
Amazon ↗

Charging Cables (USB-C / Lightning) — ~$8
Keep one dedicated set in the kit
Amazon ↗

Printed Emergency Contacts — Free
Campus health, urgent care, crisis line, family
Print at home — no purchase needed

Hard-Copy Isolation Procedures — Free
CDC / campus protocol printed; for offline reference
Print from CDC.gov

D Hygiene & Sanitation

Soap (travel bar or liquid) — ~$3
Hand hygiene — WHO first-line intervention
Target ↗

Toothbrush + Toothpaste — ~$5
Spare set kept in kit bag
CVS ↗

Tissues — ~$7
Respiratory hygiene; reduce surface contamination
Amazon ↗

Small Trash Bags — ~$6
Safe disposal of contaminated waste during isolation
Amazon ↗

E Documentation & Essentials

Waterproof Pouch (or zip-lock bag) ~$10
Contains: student ID copy, insurance card, medication list
Amazon ↗

Small Amount of Cash On hand
$20–40; card readers may be unavailable

Spare Glasses / Contact Lens Supplies On hand
Or a written prescription; often forgotten in emergencies

F Mental Health & Stability

Notebook + Pen On hand
Journaling; also for coursework during isolation

Comfort Item (tea, snack, etc.) ~$3
Psychological stability improves adherence to health guidance

Book or Offline Downloaded Content On hand
Reduce screen fatigue; maintain cognitive engagement

HOW THIS KIT DIFFERS FROM STANDARD CDC / FEMA GUIDELINES

- Removed heavy water/food stockpiles — dorm access to campus dining limits storage feasibility
- Added mental health section — isolation in dorm housing creates distinct psychological risk
- Added high-filtration masks and rapid tests — not included in general FEMA emergency kits
- All items compact and portable — fits in a single backpack for a mobile, high-density living context

CDC (2024a)
Build an emergency kit

CDC (2024b)
Pandemic flu planning checklist

WHO (2023)
COVID-19 advice for the public

Ready.gov (2024)
Emergency supply list

Ferguson et al. (2020)
Imperial College COVID-19 NPI modelling

American Red Cross (2021)
Focused updates and guidelines